

Vibe coding is like *vibe cooking* at home: experimenting just for you.

Engineering is like cooking for guests.

When others depend on it, the work changes.

Before AI, every team asked:

How much engineering discipline can we afford?

Architecture, testing, and documentation have always competed with time and cost.

Now:

AI lowers the barrier to implementation.

But it can help us do the engineering too.

Many of these principles are classic.

What's changed is what it costs to follow them.

The catch:

AI can amplify *bad* engineering just as fast.

More code, more debt, quicker.

The goal isn’t to constrain AI. It’s to direct it.

Four ways to direct it:

I.

Think Before You Generate

"Build the map before building the roads."

01 Design before prompting

04 Maintain traceability

II.

Generate Responsibly

"AI generates.
Humans own."

07 Treat AI artifacts as engineering artifacts

08 Externalize memory

III.

Prove It Works

“AI optimizes for the happy path. Attackers don’t.”

09 Testing is mandatory

11 Build evidence, not just confidence

IV.

Build for the Future

"Reuse what compounds. Delete what doesn't."

13 Documentation is part of development

15 Reduce technical debt as you go

Ready to move past vibe coding?

Pick your scale, then make these principles your team’s working agreement.

Prototype

Product

Production

Humans and AI agents alike.

Scaling down is a decision, not drift.

Not a methodology. Ideas I’m testing.

Some might be wrong, and I’d like them challenged.

First case study is in the oven. More soon. 🧁

What are you seeing?

FULL DOCUMENT

github.com/miguelmog10/ai-assisted-software-engineering

CONNECT

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